

Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan adopts open source software!

The Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan has opted for open source software over Microsoft Office. Open Office has been installed on computers at 419 schools in Karnataka. With this move, Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan has been able to save Rs 5.36 million, which would have otherwise been invested in Microsoft's software.

Around 335 schools (with an additional 84 schools) will get five desktops and one UPS system each under Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan's Computer Aided Learning scheme. Though they have opted for the open source office software suite, the operating system is still Windows 7.

The District Institutes of Education and Training (DIETs) will get both teachers and trainers acquainted with the open source software, imparting training in both MS Office and Open Office.



An app store for banned Android apps

Koushik Dutta, an Android developer, is building an Android app store that will host only applications that have been banned by Google's official Android app store, the Android Market. The alternative Android app store, called the CyanogenMod App Store, will include customised ROMs, classic games banned due to copyright complaints, unofficial tethering apps, visual voice-mail apps, one-click rooting apps and more.

This also means that if you wish to make use of these apps, you need to root your device. The process of rooting an Android device involves hacking the original Android system.



Here comes Joomla! 2.5

The Joomla! Project has announced the availability of version 2.5.0 of the open source PHP-based content management system (CMS). This new version of Joomla! comes with many new features and fixes holes too. Version 2.5.0 comes after the 1.7 release and is a long-term support (LTS) version, which will be supported for at least 18 months.

Joomla! 2.5 includes support for Microsoft SQL Server, whereas the previous versions were only compatible with the MySQL database. The new version will have support for other databases as well.



An open source malware analysis tool

Shadowserver has launched a free Web-based malware analysis tool to cater to the needs of vendor-controlled and proprietary systems. The tool, called Malwr, is designed to provide security professionals with a free and customisable open source malware analysis tool. The tool is actually a

Access a locked computer with X.org server

The French blogger 'Gu1' reveals that it is possible for anyone to access a locked computer with versions 1.11 and above of X.org's X Server. When one simultaneously presses the Ctrl key, the Alt key and the * key on the numeric keyboard, a user's screen-saver gets disabled, thus unlocking the computer. Gu1 explains that the 'AllowClosedownGrabs' debug option causes the problem. If it is active, pressing the above-mentioned key combination makes any processes that require mouse or keyboard inputs to shut down.

Google's Sky Map for Android goes open source

Google's Sky Map for Android, created by a group of Google developers based in Pittsburgh, has gone open source. The augmented-reality astronomy



app was one of the first show-pieces from Android. It combines basic astronomical data overlaid on a smartphone camera to identify heavenly bodies by simply pointing the phone towards the sky.

The search giant is teaming up with Carnegie Mellon University in a partnership that will see further development of Sky Map as a series of student projects.